

E-Cell IIT Bombay - NEC Challenge

Team Titan Candidate Profile

Name: Pooja Sundaram

Team: Titan - Assistive Tech & Product Design

My Motivation

During my product design coursework, I spent time interviewing visually impaired students at a local institute. Most of their tactile learning materials were heavy, hand-embossed paper books that wore out quickly, while electronic Braille readers cost upwards of 1.5 Lakh Rupees--completely unaffordable for most families in India.

I felt compelled to design a modular, refreshable tactile display using low-voltage micro-actuators. Good design shouldn't be a luxury reserved for high-income markets; it should make everyday learning accessible for everyone. Designing durable, low-cost assistive devices is the core focus of my entrepreneurial goals.

My Expectations from E-Cell

Designing a product for specialized user groups requires deep empathy and rigorous field testing. I expect E-Cell to assist us in connecting with accessibility foundations, government schemes (like ADIP), and social impact funds.

I want NEC to help us refine our product pricing model so that we can keep devices affordable while maintaining sustainable operating margins. I also look forward to receiving pitch coaching to effectively communicate social impact alongside business viability.